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NIFT DELHI TEACHES ITS STUDENTS TO THINK AND CREATE DIFFERENTLY WITHIN A PRAGMATIC FRAME

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A STITCH FORWARD Students in a workshop at NIFT Delhi

When the pandemic forced everyone to stay indoors last year, it was business as usual at the National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT) in Delhi. The faculty adapted to technology-centred teaching methods and delivered what students expected. They were involved in research and publications and acquired online teaching skills. In a way, NIFT Delhi became a virtual institute and students' homes their institute. The advantage of online classes was especially observed when industry experts were invited to share their journeys.

The guest lectures gave students a real-life industry picture, so that they could decide which specialisation they should take. With the world a classroom, NIFT Delhi took the opportunity to invite faculty and experts from across the world to interact with students. The curriculum was revised to include more online resources in each subject to ensure availability of enough reading material.

From organising craft demonstrations in Ajrakh block printing by artisans to acquainting students with the heritage crafts of India, such as handblock printing of Bagh, Patola, metal embroidery, dhurrie and Kalakshetra saree weaving, everything was organised re-

Among the recent changes the institute has adopted is to offer students interdisciplinary minors